

James Watling

Engineering Leader & Technical Innovation Expert

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Executive Summary

Engineering leader with 13+ years of experience in startup growth and technical innovation. Track record of successful exits and fundraising rounds totaling \$39M+. Expert in building high-performing remote teams and implementing AI solutions. Most recently driving AI-powered engagement features and platform transformation at Spring Health. Previously led provider experience transformation at Wonderschool post-acquisition of EarlyDay, where as Founding CTO secured \$4M+ in funding. Expert at taking products from zero to one and building and scaling teams to support business goals.

Core Competencies

- **Technical Leadership:** Remote team building, AI initiatives, platform architecture
- **Strategic Growth:** M&A experience, fundraising, technical due diligence, hiring
- **Preferred Technology:** Ruby on Rails, React, Typescript, Postgres, Next.js, GCP/AWS, AI/LLM Integration

Professional Experience

Spring Health | Associate Director of Engineering

Mar 2025 – Present

- Oversee 15 engineers across two teams, driving platform reliability and feature delivery
- Led overhaul of video therapy platform, improving stability and patient experience
- Drove AI-powered engagement features, reducing member ejection rate from 16% to 6%
- Hiring and mentoring engineers, building a high-performance engineering culture

Wonderschool (Series B) | Senior Engineering Manager

Feb 2024 – Mar 2025

- Led multiple engineering teams (14 engineers) across distributed tech stacks and projects
- Implemented new SDLC improving deployment frequency by 300% and reducing support tickets by 85%
- Established structured hiring process, successfully scaling team with 8 direct hires
- Drove technical strategy and platform consolidation post-acquisition

EarlyDay (Acquired by Wonderschool) | Founding CTO

Feb 2022 – Feb 2024

- Built product from scratch and scaled to processing 100,000s of job matches and recommendations
- Led growth from solo founder to team of 6 engineers with 100% retention through acquisition
- Pioneered AI implementation reducing approval time from 48 hours to <2 minutes
- Scaled platform to handle 1000s of new users monthly while maintaining performance
- Secured \$4M+ in funding and led technical due diligence for successful acquisition

Hub | Senior Software Engineer

Dec 2018 – Feb 2022

- Key contributor to \$20M token sale through technical leadership
- Architected core platform features and blockchain integration
- Collaborated with LinkedIn co-founder on trust protocol development

KarmaCheck (\$15M Series A) | Senior Front End Developer

Nov 2019 – Mar 2020

- Early developer building MVP contributing to successful Series A
- Established product architecture and development practices
- Continued as board advisor after transition

GuavaPass (Acquired by ClassPass) | Team Lead

Nov 2016 – Dec 2018

- Led 5-person team through successful acquisition
- Improved deployment frequency by 300% through DevOps implementation
- Conducted technical due diligence and M&A documentation

Previous Experience

- **Roomorama** | Senior Ruby on Rails Developer (Rails/Postgres/Javascript/React) *2014 – 2015*
- **Catch Design** | Web Developer (Rails/Postgres/Javascript) *2013 – 2014*
- **Consilio** | Managing Director (Rails/Postgres/Javascript) *2013 – 2014*
- **Tendersave** | Technology Director (Rails/Postgres/Javascript) *2012 – 2014*